A STUDY ON PUBLIC PERCEPTION OF FOOD DELIVERY SAFETY AND HYGIENE

PROJECT REPORT

Submitted to

SRM INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the degree of

MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE & DATA SCIENCE

Submitted by

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Under the guidance of

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project titled **"A STUDY ON PUBLIC PERCEPTION OF FOOD DELIVERYSAFETY AND HYGIENE",** in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the degree Master of Business Administration (MBA) specializing in Artificial Intelligence & Data Science, is an original work undertaken by SANJAY KUMAR N (Reg. No. RA2452008010034) during the academic year 2025 -2026 of her study at the Faculty of Management, SRM IST, Kattankulathur, under my supervision and the report has not formed the basis for the award of any Degree/Fellowship or other similar title to any candidate of any university.

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INTERNAL EXAMINER **EXTERNAL EXAMINER**

DEAN - FOM

DECLARATION

I, **SANJAY KUMAR N,** hereby declare that the Project Report, entitled **"A STUDY ON PUBLIC PERCEPTIONOF FOOD DELIVERY SAFETY AND HYGIENE"**, submitted to the **SRM IST** in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the Degree of Master of Business Administration, specializing in Artificial Intelligence & Data Science, is a record of original training undergone by me during the period **June 2025 – September 2025**, under the supervision and guidance of **Dr. U. Madhanrajan**, Faculty of Management, SRM IST, Kattankulathur and it has not formed the basis for the award of any Degree/Fellowship or other similar title to any candidate of any University.

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Date: **Signature of the Student**

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This study explores how customers perceive the safety and hygiene practices of food delivery services, with a focus on packaging, handling, delivery processes, and overall trust in online food platforms. With the growing reliance on food delivery applications, especially after the COVID-19 pandemic, consumer confidence in hygiene standards has become a critical factor influencing satisfaction, loyalty, and adoption.

The research objectives were to understand customer awareness of hygiene protocols, examine trust in delivery practices, assess perceptions of packaging safety, and identify key areas for improvement for companies and regulators. Primary data was collected through structured questionnaires targeting frequent users of food delivery services. Statistical analyses, including chi-square tests, ANOVA, and correlation, were applied to uncover relationships between customer trust, safety concerns, and satisfaction.

Key findings indicate that while most customers appreciate the convenience of delivery platforms, concerns remain around contactless delivery, packaging integrity, and hygiene compliance by delivery personnel. Trust in platforms was found to be directly linked to visible hygiene practices, such as tamper-proof packaging and transparent communication about safety protocols. Additionally, younger consumers were more adaptable to new safety features compared to older users, highlighting generational differences in perception.

The study concludes that enhancing food delivery safety requires a multi-stakeholder approach. Companies should focus on stronger hygiene protocols, regular training for delivery staff, and clear communication of safety measures to customers. Regulators can play a role in setting industry standards to ensure uniformity and build public trust. Overall, the research highlights that consumer confidence in hygiene and safety will be a defining factor in the future growth and sustainability of the online food delivery industry.

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CHAPTER - I
INTRODUCTION
AND
RESEARCH DESIGN

"A STUDY ON PUBLIC PERCEPTION OF FOOD DELIVERY SAFETY AND HYGIENE"

1.1 INTRODUCTION

The rapid advancement of technology, the growing demand for convenience, and the increasing penetration of smartphones and internet connectivity have transformed the way people access food. Food delivery applications and services have emerged as a prominent segment within the global food and hospitality industry, redefining consumer lifestyles and eating habits. In recent years, online food delivery platforms such as Swiggy, Zomato, Uber Eats, and similar international counterparts have significantly expanded, providing consumers with an extensive range of cuisines delivered directly to their doorsteps. While these services bring undeniable benefits such as convenience, variety, and time efficiency, they also raise pertinent concerns regarding the safety and hygiene of food handling, preparation, and delivery processes.

The concept of food safety is not new, but its importance has been amplified in the context of online food delivery. Traditionally, customers judged food hygiene based on visible cues in restaurants such as cleanliness, staff hygiene, and food presentation. However, with the rise of delivery systems, consumers often lack transparency about how their food is cooked, packaged, and transported. This invisibility creates uncertainty, and public perception plays a critical role in shaping trust toward food delivery platforms. Issues such as improper packaging, delayed deliveries, exposure of food to environmental contaminants, and unhygienic handling by delivery personnel have been highlighted in both consumer feedback and media reports.
These concerns are further intensified by health risks like foodborne illnesses, especially in densely populated urban areas where delivery services are most prevalent.

The COVID-19 pandemic has further shifted public attention to food delivery safety and hygiene**.** During the pandemic, millions of people relied on online food delivery as restaurants closed their dine-in services. In this context, consumers became more cautious about how their food was handled, packaged, and delivered. Practices such as contactless delivery, sealed packaging, and mandatory use of sanitizers by delivery personnel became industry norms in response to consumer concerns. The pandemic period thus created a heightened awareness of hygiene practices and significantly influenced consumer perception of safety standards in the

food delivery ecosystem. Even in the post-pandemic era, many of these concerns remain deeply embedded in public consciousness, making food safety a critical determinant of customer trust and loyalty.

Public perception of food delivery hygiene is shaped by multiple factors including personal experiences, word-of-mouth, online reviews, media reports, and marketing campaigns by delivery companies. For example, customers may develop positive perceptions if they consistently receive well-packaged food that arrives at the right temperature, while negative perceptions may arise from instances of spillage, late deliveries, or visible signs of mishandling. Additionally, socio-demographic variables such as age, income level, education, and urban–rural location may influence how consumers perceive risks associated with food delivery safety. Younger consumers might prioritize convenience and speed, while older or health-conscious individuals may be more concerned about hygiene standards.

Finally, it is important to note that the study of public perception on food delivery safety and hygiene is not only relevant from a consumer perspective but also from a public health standpoint. Unsafe food handling can lead to outbreaks of foodborne diseases, imposing costs on healthcare systems and affecting overall community well-being. Therefore, ensuring high standards of hygiene in food delivery is a shared responsibility among restaurants, delivery platforms, regulators, and consumers themselves. By understanding public perception, stakeholders can design more effective policies, strategies, and interventions to promote safe, hygienic, and trustworthy food delivery services.

1.2 IMPORTANCE OF THE STUDY IN A BUSINESS CONTEXT

This study is significant for businesses as it explores how public perception of food delivery safety and hygiene shapes customer trust and loyalty. With growing reliance on online food delivery, safety has become a critical factor influencing consumer decisions. The findings help companies identify gaps in hygiene practices such as packaging, delivery handling, and restaurant compliance. Addressing these concerns not only improves customer satisfaction but also strengthens brand reputation. Businesses that prioritize safety can gain a competitive edge in an increasingly crowded market. Insights from this study also support compliance with regulatory standards and reduce reputational risks. Communicating safety measures effectively builds stronger consumer confidence. Overall, the study provides businesses with actionable

guidance for sustainable growth in the food delivery sector.

1.3 NEED OF THE STUDY

The rapid growth of online food delivery services has created convenience for consumers but also raised serious concerns about food safety and hygiene, which directly affect trust and satisfaction. Unlike dining in restaurants, customers cannot observe how food is prepared, packaged, or transported, leading to uncertainty and skepticism. Issues such as tampered packaging, spillage, unhygienic handling, and inconsistent safety practices have increased doubts about reliability**.**

- Online food delivery services are growing rapidly but raise concerns about safety and hygiene.
- Customers cannot directly observe preparation, packaging, or delivery processes.
- Issues like tampered packaging, spillage, delays, and unhygienic handling create doubts.
- During COVID-19, hygiene and contactless delivery became essential, and concerns remain even after.
- Inconsistent implementation of safety measures by platforms increases scepticism.
- Negative perceptions spread quickly via social media, damaging brand reputation.
- *Poor* hygiene practices can cause foodborne illnesses, posing public health risks.

1.4 PRIMARY OBJECTIVE

The primary objective of this study is to evaluate the public's perception regarding the safety and hygiene practices followed in food delivery services.

1.5 SECONDARY OBJECTIVE

- To study how hygiene practices affect customer satisfaction and repeat orders. It shows the link between safety and loyalty.
- To check customer awareness of safety protocols in food delivery. This helps identify gaps in communication.
- To find consumer concerns on food handling, packaging, and delivery hygiene. It

highlights key problem areas.

- To examine how COVID-19 shaped safety perceptions in food delivery. This shows changing customer expectations.
- To recommend ways to improve safety and hygiene standards. These suggestions will guide better practices.

1.5 CHAPTER SCHEME

The research study consists of the following five chapters:

1. **The first chapter** deals with introduction, need for the study, scope of the study, objectives, limitations of the study and chapter scheme.

2. **The second chapter** covers the review of literature on evolution of Research shows that consumer perception of food delivery is strongly influenced by hygiene, packaging, and safe handling practices.

3. **The third chapter** gives a complete view of the research methodology, data collection and analysis plan of this study.

4. **The fourth chapter** involves the analysis and interpretation of the data collected through the questionnaire with statistical tools like Chi-Squared Test, One-way ANOVA, Correlation and Regression.

5. **The fifth chapter** elucidates the summary of findings, conclusions and recommendations.

CHAPTER - II
REVIEW OF LITERATURE

CHAPTER II

2.1 REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Carvalho et al. (2024) et al. examine consumer perceptions of food hygiene during COVID-19, highlighting how packaging, payment methods, and safety protocols shaped trust in food services. Carvalho et al. led design and analysis; Silva et al. managed data collection and consumer behavior across meal settings; Liboredo et al., as corresponding author, linked findings to risk perception, institutional trust, and public health policy implications.

Saleh et al. (2024) et al. investigate adolescent use of online food delivery apps in the UAE, assessing usage frequency, food choices, and perceptions of health and safety. Saleh et al. led conceptualization and analysis; the study highlights the influence of appearance, price, and taste on choices and calls for tailored interventions to promote healthier eating habits. The research offers insights into the digital food environment's impact on youth dietary behavior.

Merlyn S. Thomas and Yaohua Feng et al., 2021 Jointly conducted a comprehensive mixed-method study exploring consumer risk perception and trusted sources of food safety information during the COVID-19 pandemic in the United States. They designed and executed five waves of surveys complemented by longitudinal focus group discussions to assess how perceived risks influenced food handling behaviors, particularly handwashing practices. Their research highlighted that consumers perceived a higher risk of contracting COVID-19 from people than from food, and identified the U.S. FDA, CDC, WHO, and healthcare professionals as the most trusted information sources, while social media was the least trusted. They underscored a disconnect between heightened hand hygiene awareness due to COVID-19 and its connection to food safety, emphasizing the need for food safety educators to leverage trusted channels to sustain positive consumer behaviors beyond the pandemic.

Akahane et al., 2023 Akahane and colleagues collaboratively investigated consumer awareness of food defense using a web-based survey. Akahane led the study design and analysis, while Kanagawa, Takahata, Nakanishi, and Takemi Akahane contributed to questionnaire development, interpretation of results, and linking consumer behavior with

industry practices. Imamura added methodological and public health perspectives, ensuring the study highlighted the risks of intentional food contamination and the need for stronger consumer education and preventive measures.

Soon et al., 2022 Soon and colleagues applied Protection Motivation Theory (PMT) to study how COVID-19 shaped consumers' food shopping, hygiene, and online delivery behaviors in Malaysia and Indonesia. Soon led the conceptualization, methodology, and analysis, while Vanany, Abdul Wahab, Sani, Hamdan, and Jamaludin contributed to data collection, interpretation, and writing. Together, they highlighted the role of perceived severity, vulnerability, and self-efficacy in driving protective food safety practices, offering insights into public health strategies during and after the pandemic.

Mulyanto et al., 2023 Mulyanto, Kusumaningrum, and Wulandari examined food safety knowledge and awareness among restaurants, delivery partners, and customers using online food delivery platforms in Depok City, Indonesia. Mulyanto contributed to the survey design and statistical analysis, while Kusumaningrum provided supervision and expertise in food safety regulations. Wulandari supported data collection and interpretation, emphasizing practical issues faced during food handling and delivery. Together, they highlighted gaps in awareness despite adequate knowledge, stressing the need for training, monitoring, and safety campaigns.

Goh et al., 2022 Goh, Rahim, Kumar, and Zulfakar collectively explored how Malaysian museum visitors' experiences influence their satisfaction using the Experience Economy Theory (EET). The authors emphasized aesthetics and entertainment as key factors shaping positive visitor perceptions, while education and escapism showed weaker links. Their contributions highlighted the importance of enhancing museum environments and interactive elements to sustain cultural engagement among younger generations. This research offers practical insights for museum management to increase visitor numbers and long-term sustainability.

Ali et al., 2023 Ali, Khan, Ishaq, and Hassan investigated food safety knowledge, attitudes, and practices among street food vendors in Pakistan's Hazara Division. The authors designed a cross-sectional survey and statistical analysis to uncover gaps in vendor training and awareness. Their work highlighted that although vendors showed positive attitudes toward hygiene, their practices often lagged, posing risks to consumers. Collectively, they recommended targeted training, stricter regulation, and awareness programs to improve street food safety standards.

Adi et al. (2024) et al. investigate the dual challenges of food safety and road safety among delivery riders in Accra, revealing poor hygiene, lack of certification, and selective compliance with traffic rules. Their multidisciplinary team advocates for stricter regulations, targeted training, and collaborative interventions to protect consumers and riders.

Vogas and Souza et al. (2023) investigate Brazilian consumer perceptions of food safety risks in delivery apps, linking concerns to trust and purchasing behavior. They emphasize consumers' strategies to reduce risks, such as hygiene practices and app reliability, highlighting the importance of safety protocols, transparency, and trust-building to enhance confidence in food delivery services.

Sulistyowati et al. (2025) examine legal gaps in Indonesia's food delivery regulation, highlighting that BPOM Regulation No. 8/2020 ensures food safety but neglects driver safety. Sulistyowati led the legal framing on consumer rights, Masnun on statutory interpretation and regulatory analysis, and Prasetio on practical implications for driver hygiene and protection. They collectively argue for revising the law to include driver safety as part of consumer protection, promoting safer and fairer delivery systems.

Natissareeya Suksrimuang and Pornthipa Ongkunuk et al. (2022) studied food delivery services in Thailand during COVID-19, applying SERVQUAL and Importance-Satisfaction analysis. They identified significant service gaps, especially in assurance factors like privacy, food safety, and hygiene during delivery. Their work calls for stronger management and standards to ensure safety, reliability, and customer satisfaction in delivery systems.

Gavilan et al. (2021) et al. analyze innovations in online food delivery during COVID-19, showing how creative packaging, home-chef services, and DIY kits enhanced experiential value and consumer engagement. They find fear of contagion moderates these choices, highlighting the need to design food delivery not just for convenience but for memorable and safe dining experiences.

Hakim et al. (2022) et al. explore Brazilian consumer perceptions of dark kitchens—delivery-only restaurants without storefronts. They find that many lack clear understanding of the concept, but willingness to pay is influenced by solidarity with the foodservice sector, perceived safety, quality control, and experience. The authors emphasize the need for clearer regulations and communication to build trust, transparency, and food safety in this emerging model.

Chowdhury et al. et al. (2023) investigate customer satisfaction and hygiene factors in online food delivery during COVID-19 in Bangladesh. They find that food and packaging quality are the key hygiene factors influencing trust and satisfaction, with cleanliness of delivery staff and delivery accuracy also important. Their analysis underscores hygiene's critical role in building customer trust and achieving sustainable business growth.

Gunawardana et al. et al. (2022) analyze human factors influencing consumer satisfaction in online food delivery during COVID-19. They find hygiene, delivery personnel behavior, and safety measures significantly impact customer trust, while technological ease of use and app reliability enhance satisfaction. The study emphasizes integrating human-centered design and safety practices to improve overall food delivery service quality.

Nashwan et al. et al. (2022) assessed food safety knowledge and risk perception among pregnant women in Jordan during COVID-19. They found limited awareness and significant gaps in handling practices, highlighting the vulnerability of pregnant women. The study calls for targeted education and interventions to improve food safety and protect maternal and fetal health.

Wai Chuen Poon et al. (2024) Poon and Tung (2024) analyzed the rise of online food delivery culture during COVID-19, applying the Model of Goal-Directed Behaviour (MGB) to assess consumer intention and risk perception. They showed that attitudes, emotions, and perceived behavioral control shape desire to use OFD, while risks such as financial, privacy, physical, and contracting COVID-19 dampen adoption. Their work advances understanding of consumer decision-making under crisis and offers strategic insights for OFD providers to reduce risks and sustain long-term adoption.

Gargiulo et al. et al. (2022) review global patterns of foodborne disease outbreaks, comparing risks from eating at home, in restaurants, and via delivery. They highlight cultural and socioeconomic factors shaping food safety outcomes and emphasize the growing role of "dark kitchens" during the pandemic. The study stresses the need for harmonized food safety standards, better sanitation, and improved surveillance to reduce foodborne illnesses worldwide.

Vandenhaute et al. et al. (2022) investigate consumer attitudes and transparency perceptions of COVID-19 safety measures in Belgium's food service sector. Surveying consumers and businesses through different pandemic stages, they reveal that consumers highly value hygiene measures, whereas businesses tend to underestimate them, creating a perception gap. The study stresses the importance of strict compliance and transparent communication to rebuild trust and encourage restaurant revisits during and after health crises.

Rebecca Bennett et al. (2025) investigated the commercial determinants of health in the online food delivery sector, focusing on Uber Eats in Australia. Their study revealed how marketing strategies targeting families, labour exploitation within the gig economy, and corporate influences negatively impact public health. They emphasized the urgent need for regulatory measures to protect nutrition, equity, and worker welfare against expanding corporate power in this sector

Wisnu Pujiantoro et al. (2025) examined the "safety paradox" among young food-delivery platform workers in Indonesia, focusing on 118 GoFood riders. Their study revealed that higher risk perceptions paradoxically led to more risky riding behaviors, while strong safety attitudes significantly reduced unsafe practices. Using quantitative survey data and PLS-SEM analysis, they contributed theoretical insights on the limits of risk awareness and offered practical recommendations to reform platform incentive systems and strengthen safety interventions. Collectively, the authors highlighted the urgent need for systemic reforms to balance efficiency demands with rider safety in the gig economy

AlTarrah et al. (2021) examined how COVID-19 affected food purchasing, eating habits, and safety perceptions in Kuwait. AlTarrah led the methodology and analysis, while AlShami, AlHamad, and AlBesher shaped the study's design and policy relevance. Devarajan contributed statistical rigor, ensuring reliable findings. Together, the authors highlighted how restrictions and uncertainty reshaped consumer behavior and trust in food systems.

Fan Cheong et al. (2022) showed how Macau restaurants adapted to online food delivery during COVID-19, focusing on food quality and service. Rebecca Bennett et al. (2025) found that Uber Eats' corporate practices in Australia harmed public health and worker welfare, urging regulation. Wisnu Pujiantoro et al. (2025) revealed that Indonesian delivery riders often engage in risky behavior despite safety awareness, calling for platform reforms. Together, these studies highlight challenges and suggest reforms in the digital food delivery ecosystem during the pandemic.

Li, Y. et al. (2022) The authors conducted a thematic review on consumers' use of food delivery services during the COVID-19 pandemic. They identified eight key themes influencing consumer behavior such as technical factors, emotional motivations, and service quality, while highlighting distinct COVID-19-related impacts such as perceived risks and social responsibility. Their work provides comprehensive insights into evolving consumer trends and sets directions for post-pandemic research and industry practices.

Lu et al. (2022) identify that traffic violations by food delivery workers are mainly caused by high order volumes during peak hours and insufficient delivery time. They propose a hierarchical delivery system allowing customers to choose delivery speed with fees, which spreads demand and reduces driver pressure and violations. Their model, supported by survey data and price sensitivity analysis, aims to improve delivery quality, worker safety, and industry sustainability. This approach addresses the root cause rather than only penalizing drivers, offering a practical solution for safer food delivery services.

Muangmee et al. (2021) used the UTAUT model to study food delivery app usage in Bangkok during COVID-19. They found performance expectancy, effort expectancy, social influence, timeliness, task-technology fit, trust, and safety significantly drive users' intention to use the apps. Timeliness, task fit, and trust were the strongest factors, highlighting the need for apps to be reliable, easy to use, and safe to retain customers during the pandemic.

Dai et al. (2023) analyze how profit-seeking behaviors of major online food delivery platforms in China affect food safety risks and government regulation. Their evolutionary game model shows platforms prioritize high profits through commission and promotion fees, driving restaurants towards unsafe practices. They find that strong government regulation can promote safer production but does not alter platform profit motives. The authors recommend balanced regulation targeting both platforms and restaurants to improve food safety while maintaining platform profitability.

Byrd et al. (2021) explore U.S. consumers' perceptions of COVID-19 risks from restaurant food and packaging during the pandemic. They find that consumers were moderately concerned, especially about dine-in food and cold or uncooked items, influenced by knowledge gaps, heuristics, and trust levels. Risk perceptions were higher among women, high-risk individuals, African Americans, and those worried about food affordability. The study suggests that clear, emotionally appealing communication from restaurants and public health officials is needed to correct misperceptions and support the industry during health crises.

Papakostopoulos et al. (2021) examine risky driving behaviors among food delivery riders in Athens, Greece, linking these behaviors to work conditions and demographics. They find that serious offenses like red-light running and helmet nonuse are associated with young age, low experience, personal vehicle use, and payment by the hour, reflecting pressure for fast deliveries and income. Minor offenses are widespread and normalized among riders. The study highlights a poor safety culture, suggesting interventions such as legal responsibility for employers, promoting safe practices tied to customer tipping, and stricter age-related regulations to improve rider safety.

CHAPTER - III
PROBLEM
STATEMENT AND SCOPE

CHAPTER III

3.1 PROBLEM STATEMENT

The food delivery industry has grown rapidly, especially with the rise of digital platforms and post-pandemic demand. However, concerns about safety and hygiene continue to influence customer trust in these services. Consumers often question whether food is handled properly, whether packaging is tamper-proof, and if delivery practices are safe. Inconsistent standards across restaurants and delivery companies create uncertainty and reduce consumer confidence. This lack of trust may affect repeat purchases, customer loyalty, and overall brand reputation. Although businesses have introduced hygiene protocols, their visibility and effectiveness from the customer's perspective remain unclear. Regulatory measures exist but are not always enforced or communicated to the public. Therefore, it is necessary to examine public perception of food delivery safety and hygiene to identify gaps, build trust, and guide improvements for sustainable business growth.

3.2 SCOPE OF THE STUDY

- The study examines consumer perceptions of food delivery safety and hygiene, focusing on trust, confidence, and satisfaction.
- It evaluates packaging quality, delivery handling, and visible hygiene practices that influence customer loyalty.
- The research identifies key areas where companies, restaurants, and delivery staff need improvements.
- It considers the role of regulations and post-pandemic expectations in shaping public trust in food delivery.
- The study is limited to survey responses and does not involve laboratory testing of food quality.

3.3 LIMITATIONS OF THE STUDY

- The study is based on consumer perceptions, which may not always reflect the actual hygiene practices of companies and restaurants.
- Data collection is limited to the selected sample and region, so results may not represent the views of all consumers.
- Responses rely on self-reported data, which may include personal bias or inaccurate recall by participants.
- The study does not involve laboratory or technical testing of food safety and focuses only on perceived hygiene.
- Rapid changes in industry practices or new regulations may affect perceptions beyond the scope of this research.

CHAPTER - IV

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

CHAPTER IV
RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

4.1.1 RESEARCH DESIGN

This study follows a **descriptive research design** to assess public perceptions of food delivery safety and hygiene. A structured **questionnaire survey** is used to collect data from consumers who regularly use online food delivery services. The research adopts a **quantitative approach**, applying statistical tools such as regression and comparative analysis. Sampling is carried out within a specific region and timeframe to ensure relevance of findings. The design focuses on perceptions of hygiene, packaging, and delivery handling rather than technical food testing. This approach helps identify consumer expectations, satisfaction levels, and areas for business improvement.

4.1.2 POPULATION

The population of this study includes consumers who actively use online food delivery services such as Zomato, Swiggy, or Uber Eats. It covers individuals from various age groups, occupations, and income levels within the selected region. This group represents the real users whose perceptions of safety and hygiene directly impact business practices.

4.2 RESEARCH INSTRUMENT

The structured questionnaire consists of 20 questions designed to explore public perceptions of food delivery safety and hygiene. The questionnaire begins with demographic questions to capture basic information such as age, gender, occupation, and frequency of using food delivery services. The next section includes items assessing the respondent's confidence in hygiene practices followed by restaurants, delivery staff, and food delivery platforms. Participants are then asked to rate their perceptions regarding packaging quality, cleanliness of delivery practices, and overall safety of delivered food using a five-point Likert scale (ranging from "Strongly Agree" to "Strongly Disagree"). The final section focuses on identifying areas where companies, restaurants, and regulators need improvement, as well as the factors that influence customer trust and satisfaction with food delivery services.

4.3 SAMPLE

A sample is a procedure of selection of people from a population for a research study. The

sample so selected should ideally represent the whole population.

4.3.1 SAMPLE SIZE

The sample size for this study is 138. The sample respondents were persons from diverse demographic backgrounds.

4.3.2 SAMPLING TECHNIQUE

This study uses a **convenience sampling technique** to collect responses from consumers who actively use online food delivery services. Since the target population is broad and diverse, convenience sampling allows easy access to respondents through online surveys distributed via Google Forms. The approach ensures that participants include individuals from different age groups, occupations, and income levels who frequently order food through delivery platforms. Although the method does not guarantee full representation of the entire population, it is suitable for perception-based studies as it provides quick and reliable insights within the available time and resources.

4.4 DATA COLLECTION

The data for this study research has been collected from both primary and secondary sources.

4.4.1 PRIMARY DATA

The primary data for this study was collected directly from consumers through a structured Google Form questionnaire on food delivery safety and hygiene.

4.4.2 SECONDARY DATA

Secondary data was collected through the previous years' research papers, journals, articles, newspaper reports, blogs, and conference proceedings.

4.4.3 PERIOD OF STUDY

The survey was done between June and September 2025.

4.5 TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

- Google Forms for survey design and data collection
- Microsoft Excel for data cleaning and preparation

- PYTHON for statistical analysis including correlation, regression, ANOVA, and Chi-square tests

4.6 TECHNIQUES

- Descriptive statistics to summarize responses on consumer confidence, packaging safety, and delivery hygiene.
- Likert-scale analysis for measuring perceptions of hygiene practices, packaging quality, and delivery safety.
- Chi-square tests to explore associations between demographic variables (e.g., age, gender, frequency of orders) and hygiene perceptions.
- ANOVA to examine differences in perceptions across demographic groups such as age, occupation, or income.
- Correlation and Regression analysis to identify relationships between hygiene confidence, packaging safety, delivery practices, and overall customer trust.

CHAPTER - V

DATA COLLECTION AND ANALYSIS

CHAPTER V

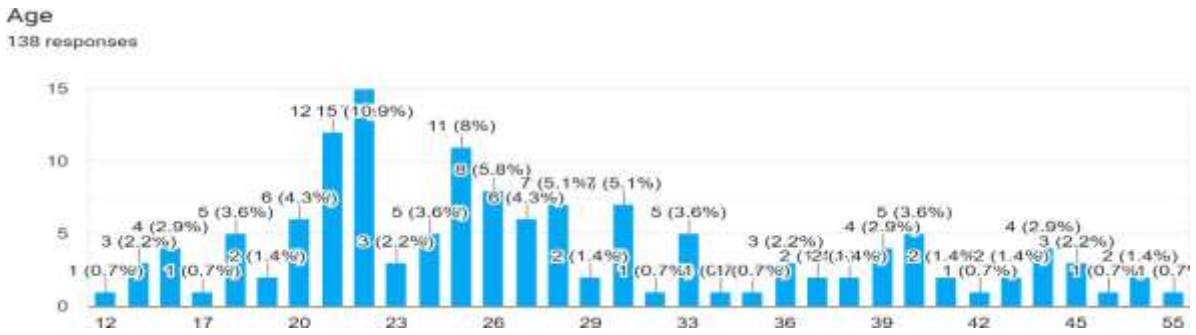
ANALYSIS

5.1 PERCENTAGE ANALYSIS

TABLE 5.1: PROFILE OF RESPONDENTS

5.1.1 AGE OF RESPONDANTS (MAJORITY OF PARTICIPANTS ARE BETWEEN 20- AND 23-YEARS OLD)

S.NO	AGE	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	21	15	**10.9%**
2	22	12	**8.7%**
3	23	11	**8%**
TOTAL		**138**	

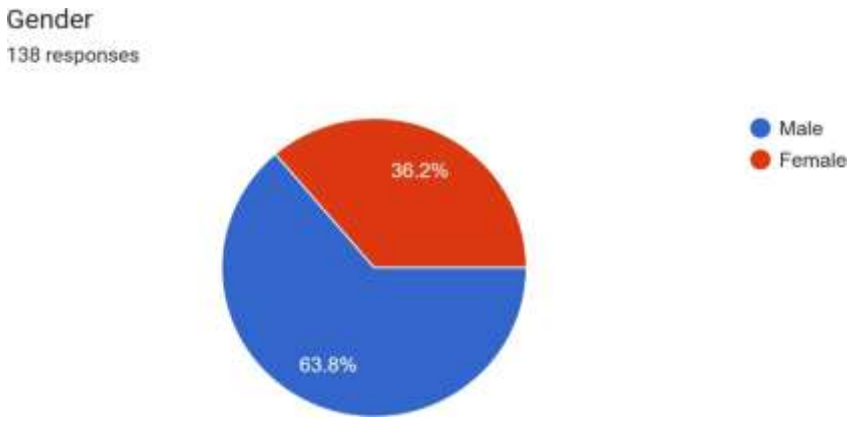


INFERENCE

The survey respondents belong to a wide range of age groups, from 12 years to 55 years. The majority of participants are between 20 and 23 years old, with the highest response at 21 years (15 respondents = 10.9%) followed by 22 years (12 respondents = 8.7%) and 23 years (11 respondents = 8%).

TABLE 5.1:2 GENDER OF RESPONDANTS

S.NO	GENDER	NO OF RESPONDANTS	% OF RESPONDANTS
1	MALE	88	63.8%
2	FEMALE	50	36.2%
3	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100**

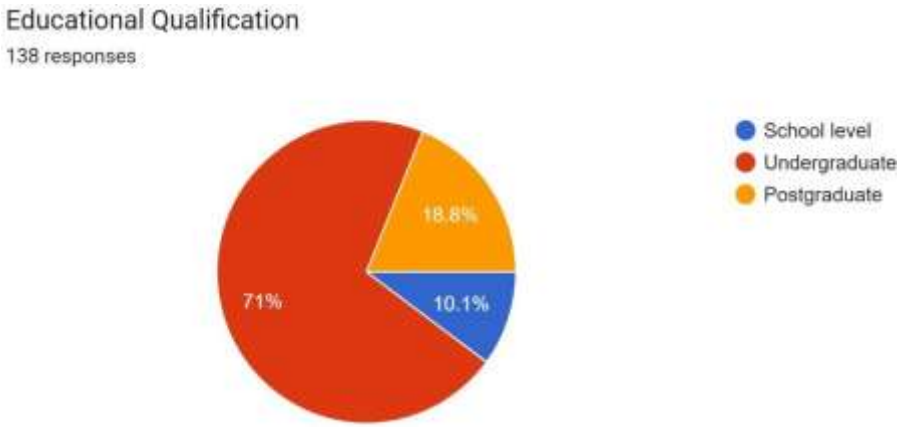


INFERENCE

Out of the total 138 respondents, 88 (63.8%) are male and 50 (36.2%) are female. This shows that the majority of participants in the survey are male. Since males form nearly two-thirds of the respondents, the findings of the study may reflect a stronger male perspective compared to female perceptions. However, both genders are represented, giving scope to compare views across groups.

TABLE 5.1:3 EDUCATIONAL QUALIFICATION OF RESPONDANTS

S.NO	EDUCATIONAL QUALIFICATION	NO OF RESPONDANTS	% OF RESPONDANTS
1	School level	14	10.1%
2	Under qualification	98	71%
3	Postgraduate	26	18.8%
4	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

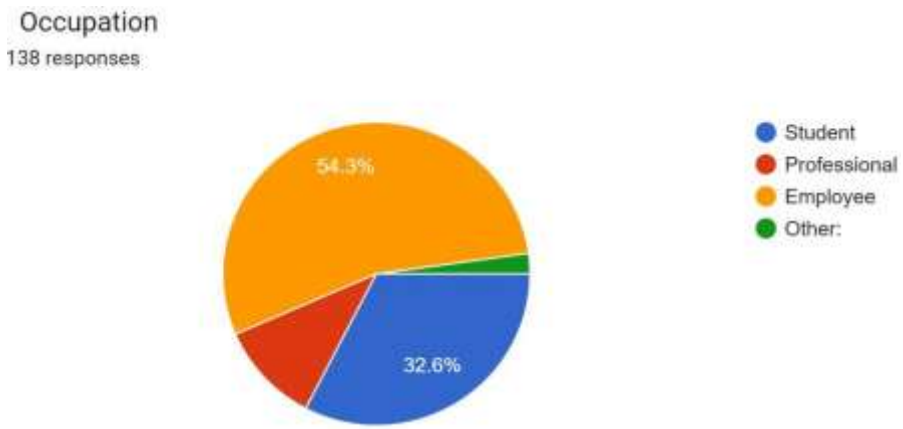


INFERENCE

The majority of respondents *are* undergraduates (71%), followed by postgraduates (18.8%), while only 10.1% are at the school level. This indicates that the survey sample is dominated by individuals with higher education, particularly undergraduates, who are also the major users of online food delivery services. Since educated youth form the bulk of respondents, their opinions are likely to strongly influence the overall perception of food delivery safety and hygiene in this study.

TABLE 5.1:4 OCCUPATION OF RESPONDANTS

S.NO	OCCUPATION	NO OF RESPONDANTS	% OF RESPONDANTS
1	Student	45	32.6%
2	Professional	15	10.9%
3	Employee	75	54.3%
4	Other	3	2.2%
5	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**



INFERENCE

The survey of 138 respondents shows a clear distribution of occupations. The largest group is Employees, who make up a significant majority at 54.3%. The second-largest group is Students, accounting for 32.6% of the responses. Together, these two categories represent over 86% of the total respondents, indicating that the audience is primarily composed of individuals either in the workforce or in an academic setting. The remaining smaller portions are split between ***Professionals*** and those in the ***other*** category.

TABLE 5.1:5 PLACE OF RESIDENCE RESPONDANTS

S.NO	PLACE OF RESIDENCE	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	URBAN	88	63.8%
2	SEMI- URBAN	39	28.3%
3	RURAL	11	8%
4	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

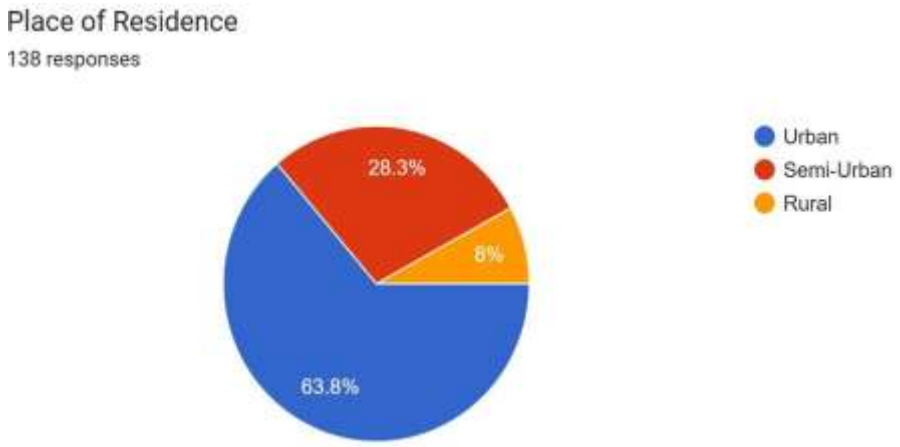


FIGURE 5.1- 5.1:5 DEMOGRAPHIC PROFILE

INFERENCE

Based on the provided pie chart, the majority of the 138 respondents reside in ***Urban*** areas, comprising 63.8% of the total. A smaller but notable portion, 28.3%, live in Semi-Urban areas, while a small minority of 8% live in Rural areas. This data indicates that the survey primarily reached an urban and semi-urban audience.

TABLE 5.2 MY PAST EXPERIENCES WITH FOOD DELIVERY HAVE BEEN HYGIENIC?

S.NO	EXPERIENCE	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	*Strongly Disagree*	6	4.3%
2	*Disagree*	7	5.1%
3	*Neutral*	29	21%
4	*Agree*	77	55.8%
5	*Strongly Agree*	19	13.8%
6	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

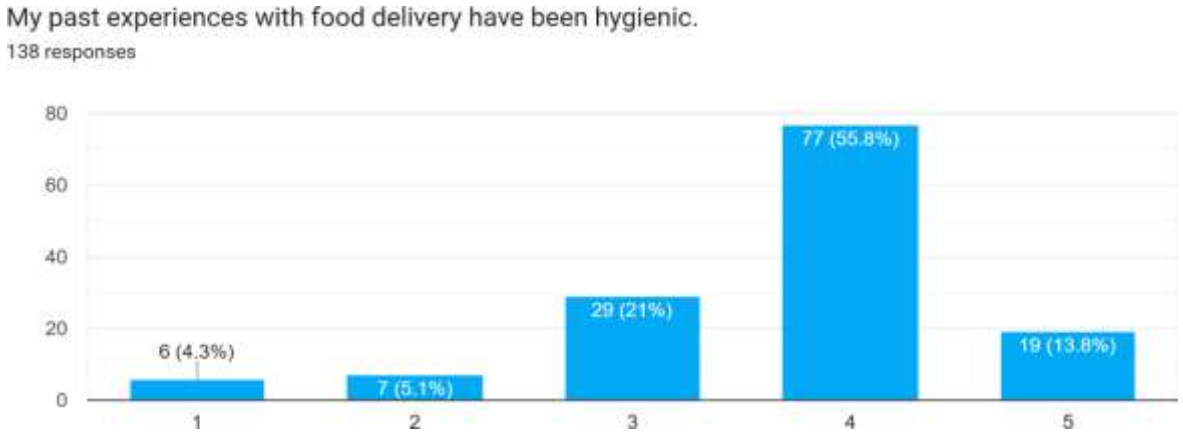


FIGURE 5.2: PAST EXPERIENCES WITH FOOD DELIVERY

INFERENCE

Based on the bar chart showing responses to the statement, "My past experiences with food delivery have been hygienic," with 138 total responses, a strong positive sentiment is evident. The highest bar is for a rating of **4**, which received 77 responses (55.8%), indicating that a clear majority of people have had a good hygienic experience. The second-highest bar is for a rating of **3**, with 29 responses (21%), suggesting a moderate or neutral experience.

TABLE 5.2:1 SEEING CLEAR HYGIENE GUIDELINES ON THE APP INCREASES MY TRUST IN ORDERING FOOD?

S.NO	TRUST	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	*Strongly Disagree*	2	1.4%
2	*Disagree*	10	7.2%
3	*Neutral*	25	18.1%
4	*Agree*	52	37.7%
5	*Strongly Agree*	49	35.5%
6	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

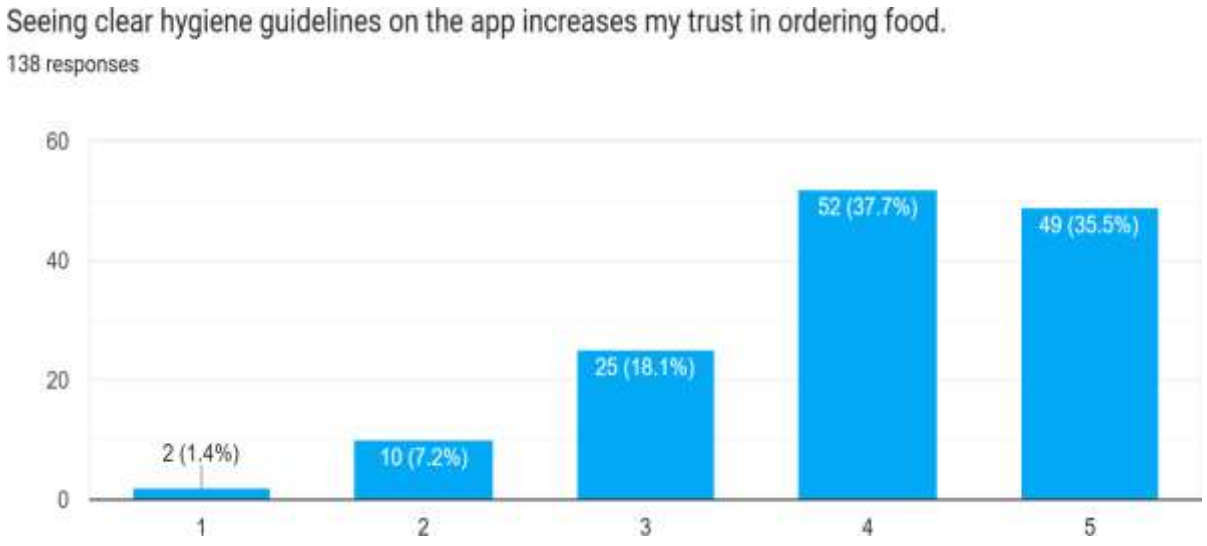


FIGURE 5.2:1 MY TRUST IN ORDERING FOOD

INFERENCE

Based on the bar chart, the majority of the 138 respondents strongly agree that seeing clear hygiene guidelines on a food delivery app increases their trust. The highest responses were for ratings of 4 (37.7%) and 5 (35.5%), collectively representing over 73% of the total. Very few respondents disagreed.

TABLE 5.2:2 DO YOU THINK FOOD SAFETY AND HYGIENE ARE IMPORTANT FOR FOOD DELIVERY SERVICES?

S.NO	IMPORTANT	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	*Strongly Disagree*	2	1.4%
2	*Disagree*	6	4.3%
3	*Neutral*	15	10.9%
4	*Agree*	53	38.4%
5	*Strongly Agree*	62	44.9%
6	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

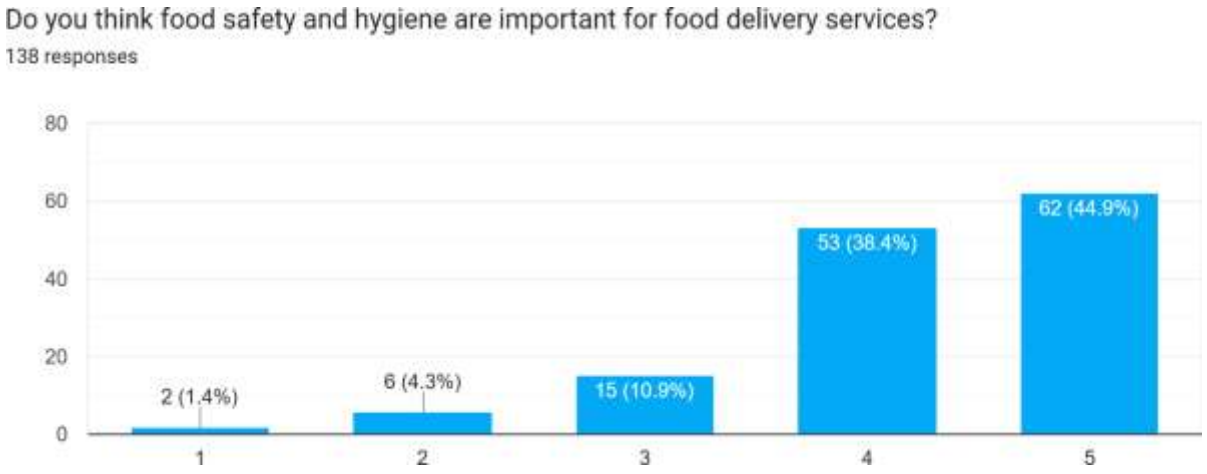


FIGURE 5.2:2 IMPORTANT FOR FOOD DELIVERY SERVICES

INFERENCE

Based on the bar chart of 138 responses, there is an overwhelming consensus that food safety and hygiene are important for food delivery services. The highest number of responses are for ratings of 5 (62 responses, 44.9%) and 4 (53 responses, 38.4%). These two categories combined represent over 83% of the total, showing a very strong agreement. This data strongly indicates that food safety and hygiene are considered a critical factor by the vast majority of consumers.

TABLE 5.2:3 HYGIENE RATINGS DISPLAYED ON APPS INFLUENCE MY ORDERING DECISIONS?

S.NO	RATINGS	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	*Strongly Disagree*	2	1.4%
2	*Disagree*	9	6.5%
3	*Neutral*	13	9.4%
4	*Agree*	72	52.2%
5	*Strongly Agree*	42	30.4%
6	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

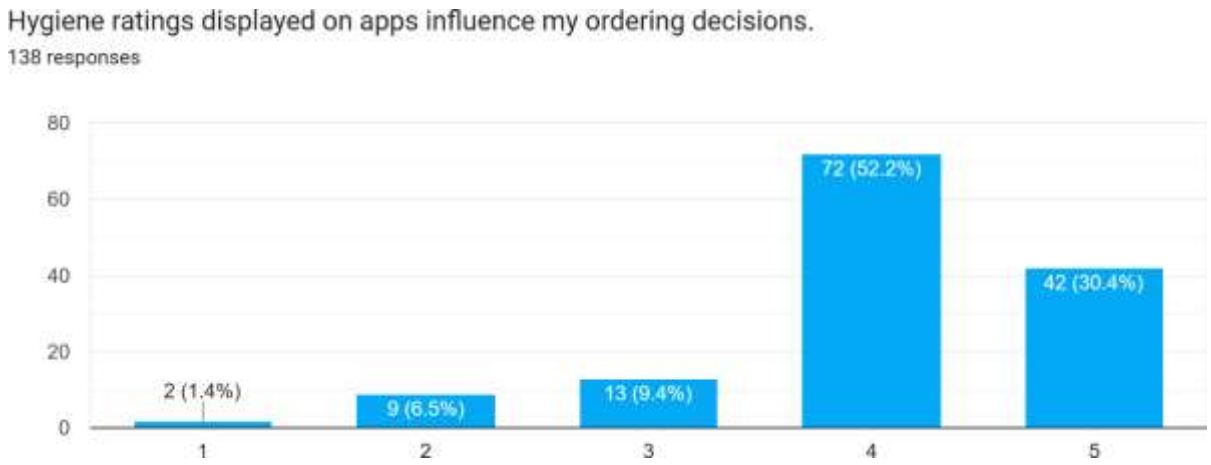


FIGURE 5.2:3 HYGIENE RATINGS DISPLAYED ON APPS

INFERENCE

The bar chart of 138 responses, a significant majority of people are influenced by hygiene ratings when ordering food. The highest responses were for ratings of 4 (72 responses, 52.2%) and 5 (42 responses, 30.4%), which together account for more than 82% of all respondents. This shows a very strong correlation between displayed hygiene ratings and consumer ordering decisions.

TABLE 5.2:4 I FEEL COMFORTABLE ORDERING FROM A NEW RESTAURANT IF IT IS LISTED ON A WELL-KNOWN DELIVERY APP?

S.NO	COMFORT	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	*Strongly Disagree*	4	2.9%
2	*Disagree*	13	9.4%
3	*Neutral*	25	18.1%
4	*Agree*	55	39.9%
5	*Strongly Agree*	41	29.7%
6	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

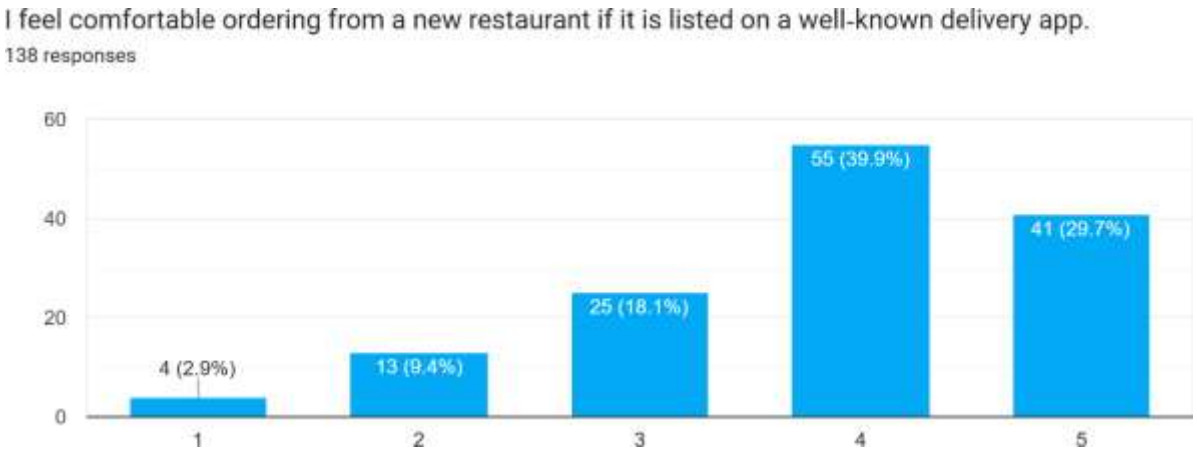


FIGURE 5.2:4 FEEL COMFORTABLE ORDERING FROM A NEW RESTAURANT

INFERENCE

The bar chart of 138 responses, a significant majority of people are comfortable ordering from a new restaurant if it is listed on a well-known delivery app. The highest responses were for ratings of 4 (55 responses, 39.9%) and 5 (41 responses, 29.7%), which together account for nearly 70% of all respondents. A moderate number of people (25 responses, 18.1%) remained neutral, while a small minority (4 responses for a rating of 1 and 13 for a rating of 2) .

TABLE 5.2:5 DO YOU THINK GOVERNMENT AUTHORITIES SHOULD MONITOR FOOD DELIVERY HYGIENE MORE STRICTLY?

S.NO	GOVERNMENT AUTHORITIES	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	*Strongly Disagree*	4	2.9%
2	*Disagree*	12	8.7%
3	*Neutral*	19	13.8%
4	*Agree*	54	39.1%
5	*Strongly Agree*	49	35.5%
6	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

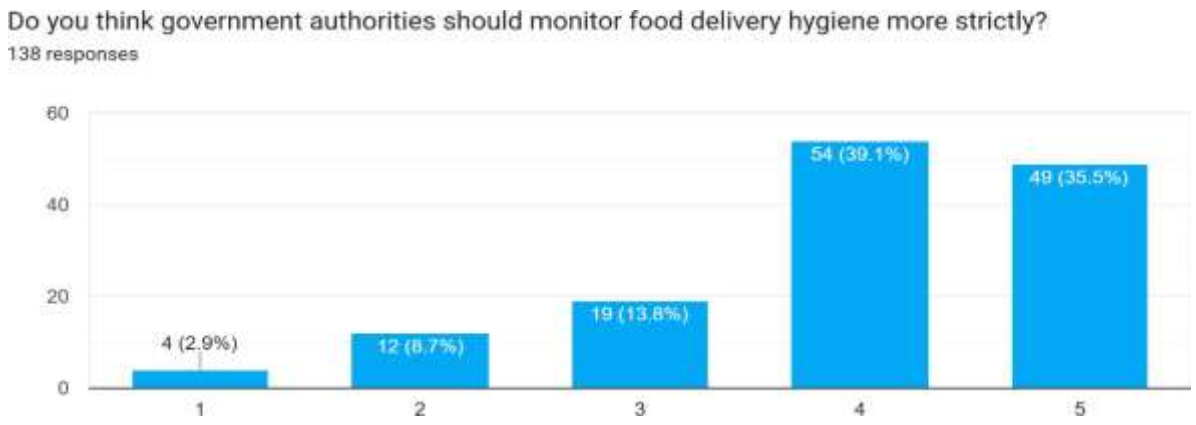


FIGURE 5.2:5 GOVERNMENT AUTHORITIES SHOULD MONITOR FOOD DELIVERY HYGIENE

INFERENCE

The bar chart of 138 responses, a significant majority of people believe that government authorities should monitor food delivery hygiene more strictly. The highest responses were for ratings of 4 (54 responses, 39.1%) and 5 (49 responses, 35.5%), which combined make up over 74% of all respondents. This clearly indicates a strong desire for increased regulatory oversight. A small number of people were neutral (19 responses, 13.8%), while very few disagreed, with only 4 responses for a rating of 1 and 12 for a rating of 2.

TABLE 5.2:6 HAVE YOU EVER RECEIVED FOOD THAT APPEARED UNHYGIENIC OR UNSAFE (E.G., OPEN PACKAGING, SPILLAGE)?

S.NO	UNSAFE	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	*Strongly Disagree*	5	3.6%
2	*Disagree*	13	9.4%
3	*Neutral*	18	13%
4	*Agree*	57	41.3%
5	*Strongly Agree*	45	32.8%
6	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

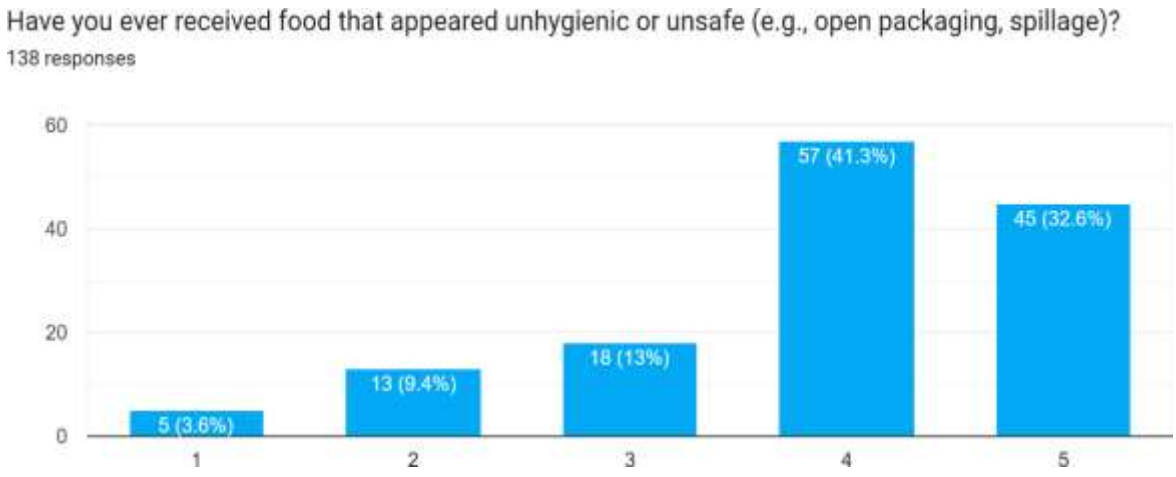


FIGURE 5.2:6 FOOD THAT APPEARED UNHYGIENIC OR UNSAFE

INFERENCE

The chart, a significant portion of the 138 respondents have received unhygienic or unsafe food. Ratings of 4 (41.3%) and 5 (32.6%) were the most common, indicating that nearly three-quarters of the people surveyed have had a negative experience with open packaging or spillage. This suggests that despite overall positive perceptions, specific hygiene lapses are a common issue.

TABLE 5.2:7 DELIVERED FOOD IS USUALLY FRESH AND

WELL-HANDLED?

S.NO	FRESH	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	*Strongly Disagree*	2	1.4%
2	*Disagree*	9	6.5%
3	*Neutral*	20	14.5%
4	*Agree*	61	44.2%
5	*Strongly Agree*	46	33.3%
6	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

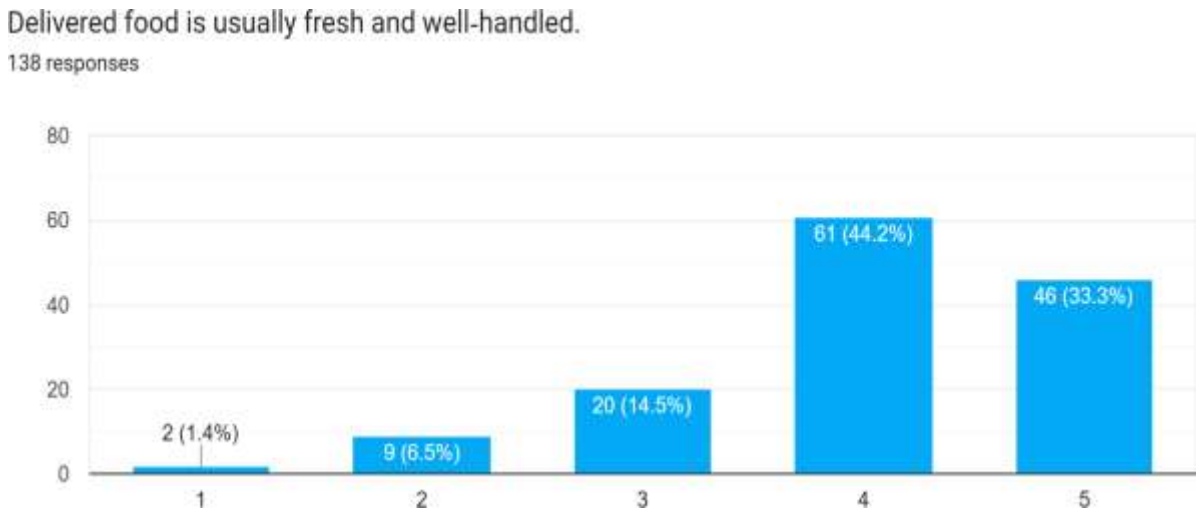


FIGURE 5.2:7 FOOD THAT APPEARED UNHYGIENIC OR UNSAFE

INFERENCE

The chart of 138 responses, the majority of people are comfortable ordering from new restaurants on a well-known delivery app. The highest responses were for ratings of 4 and 5, which together make up nearly 70% of the total, indicating a high level of trust in the platform itself. Only a small minority of respondents expressed discomfort with this practice.

TABLE 5.2:8 I BELIEVE FOOD TEMPERATURE IS MAINTAINED PROPERLY DURING DELIVERY?

S.NO	TEMPERATURE	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	*Strongly Disagree*	3	2.2%
2	*Disagree*	6	4.3%
3	*Neutral*	27	19.6%
4	*Agree*	53	38.4%
5	*Strongly Agree*	49	35.5%
6	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

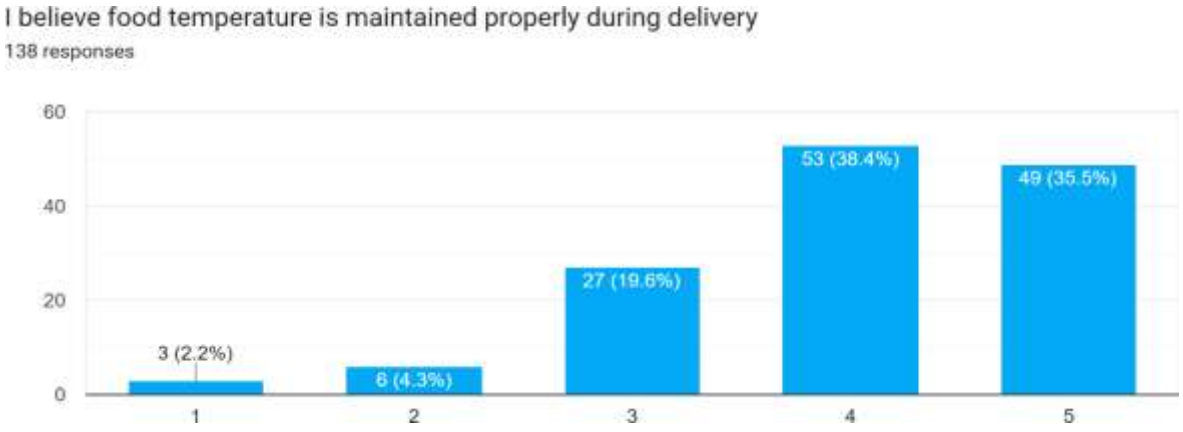


FIGURE 5.2:8 BELIEVE FOOD TEMPERATURE IS MAINTAINED PROPERLY

INFERENCE

The bar chart of 138 responses, a significant majority of people believe that food temperature is maintained properly during delivery. The highest responses were for ratings of 4 and 5, which together account for over 73% of all respondents. This shows a high level of satisfaction and trust in the delivery process.

TABLE 5.2:9 I FEEL CONFIDENT ABOUT THE SAFETY OF FOOD ORDERED THROUGH DELIVERY APPS.?

S.NO	CONFIDENT	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	*Strongly Disagree*	1	0.7%
2	*Disagree*	7	5.1%
3	*Neutral*	26	18.8%
4	*Agree*	52	37.7%
5	*Strongly Agree*	52	37.7%
6	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

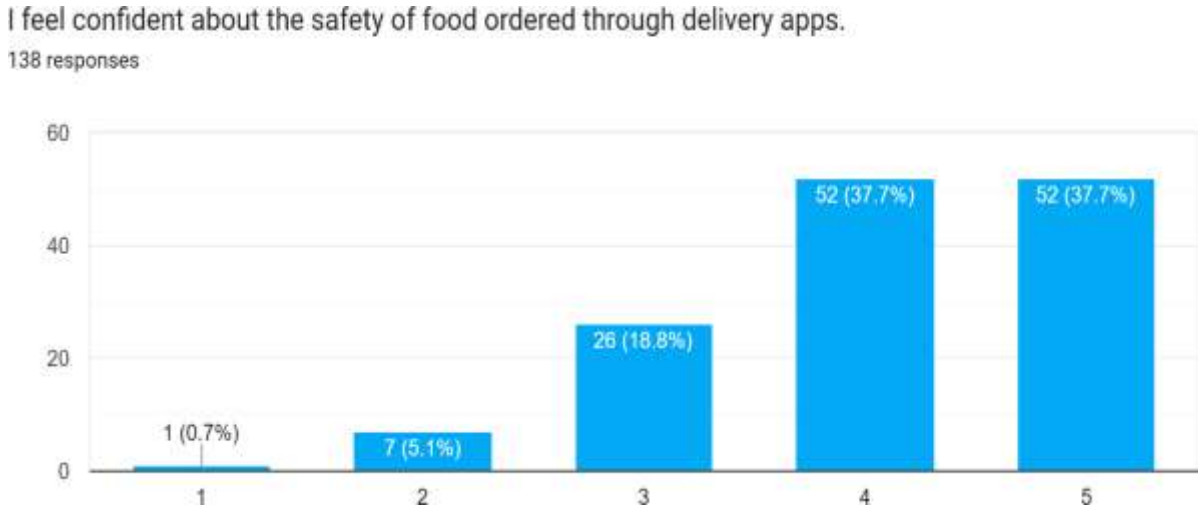


FIGURE 5.2:9 FEEL CONFIDENT ABOUT THE SAFETY OF FOOD

INFERENCE

The data shows that a majority of respondents feel confident about the safety of food ordered through delivery apps. Specifically, 75.4% of them rated their confidence as 4 or 5 on a scale of 1 to 5. Only a small percentage (5.8%) expressed low confidence with ratings of 1 or 2. This indicates generally positive trust in the safety of food delivered via these apps.

TABLE 5.2:10 I BELIEVE INSULATED DELIVERY BAGS ARE REGULARLY CLEANED AND SANITIZED?

S.NO	SANITIZED	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	*Strongly Disagree*	6	4.3%
2	*Disagree*	9	6.5%
3	*Neutral*	23	16.7%
4	*Agree*	44	31.9%
5	*Strongly Agree*	56	40.6%
6	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

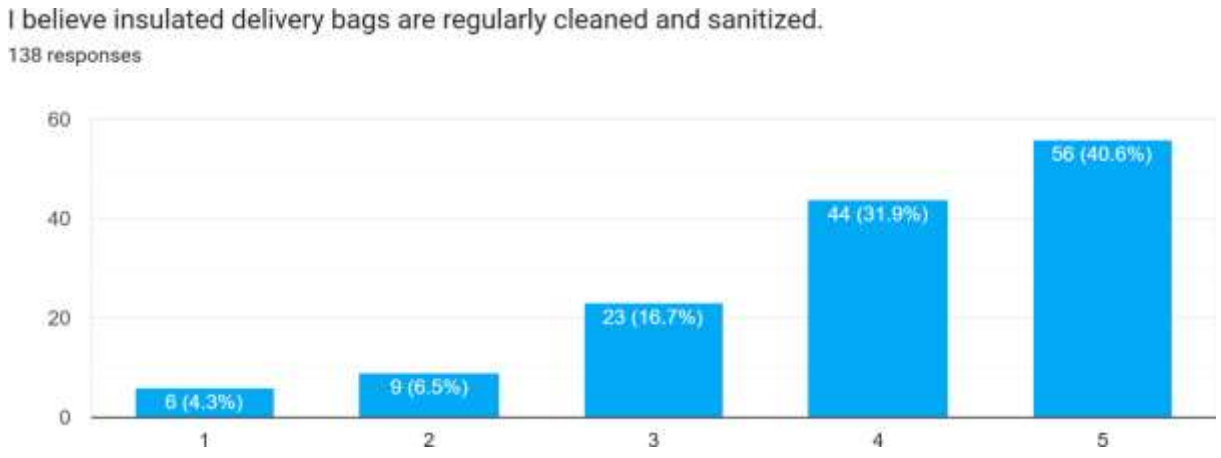


FIGURE 5.2:10 CLEANED AND SANITIZED

INFERENCE

The chart of 138 responses, a significant majority of people believe that insulated delivery bags are regularly cleaned and sanitized. The highest responses were for ratings of 5 (56 responses, 40.6%) and 4 (44 responses, 31.9%), which together make up over 72% of all respondents. This shows a high level of consumer trust in the hygiene of delivery equipment.

TABLE 5.2:11 LATE-NIGHT FOOD DELIVERIES MAINTAIN THE SAME HYGIENE STANDARDS AS DAYTIME DELIVERIES?

S.NO	LATENIGHT	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	*Strongly Disagree*	6	4.3%
2	*Disagree*	3	2.2%
3	*Neutral*	22	15.9%
4	*Agree*	58	42%
5	*Strongly Agree*	49	35.5%
6	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

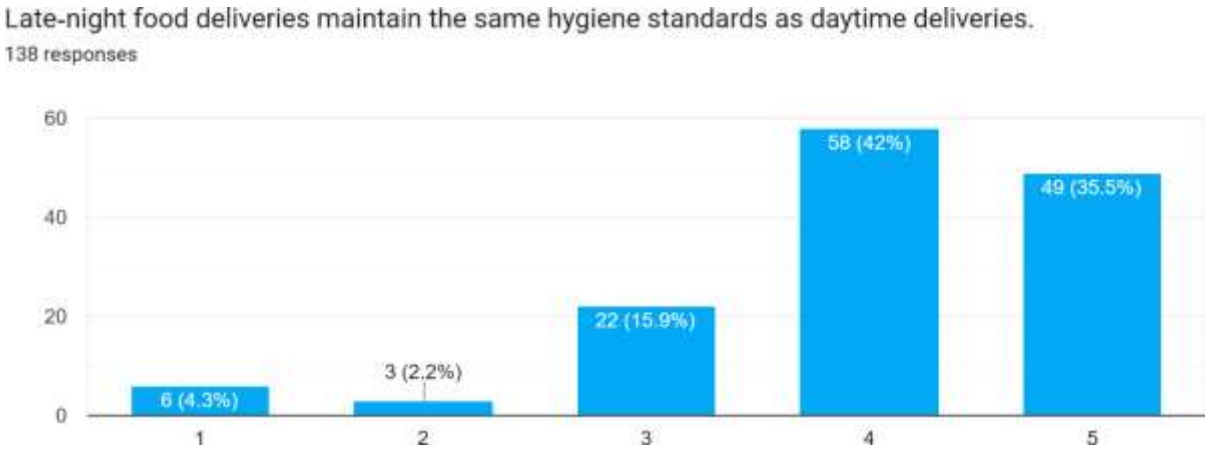


FIGURE 5.2:11 LATE-NIGHT FOOD DELIVERIES

INFERENCE

The bar chart of 138 responses, a significant majority of people believe that late-night food deliveries maintain the same hygiene standards as daytime deliveries. The highest responses were for ratings of 4 (58 responses, 42%) and 5 (49 responses, 35.5%), which together account for over 77% of all respondents. This shows a high level of confidence in the consistency of hygiene practices across different times of the day.

TABLE 5.2:12 I BELIEVE CUSTOMER FEEDBACK ON HYGIENE LEADS TO ACTUAL IMPROVEMENTS BY THE APP?

S.NO	FEEDBACK	NO OF RESPONDANTS	%OF RESPONDANTS
1	*Strongly Disagree*	6	4.3%
2	*Disagree*	3	2.2%
3	*Neutral*	22	15.9%
4	*Agree*	58	42%
5	*Strongly Agree*	49	35.5%
6	**TOTAL**	**138**	**100%**

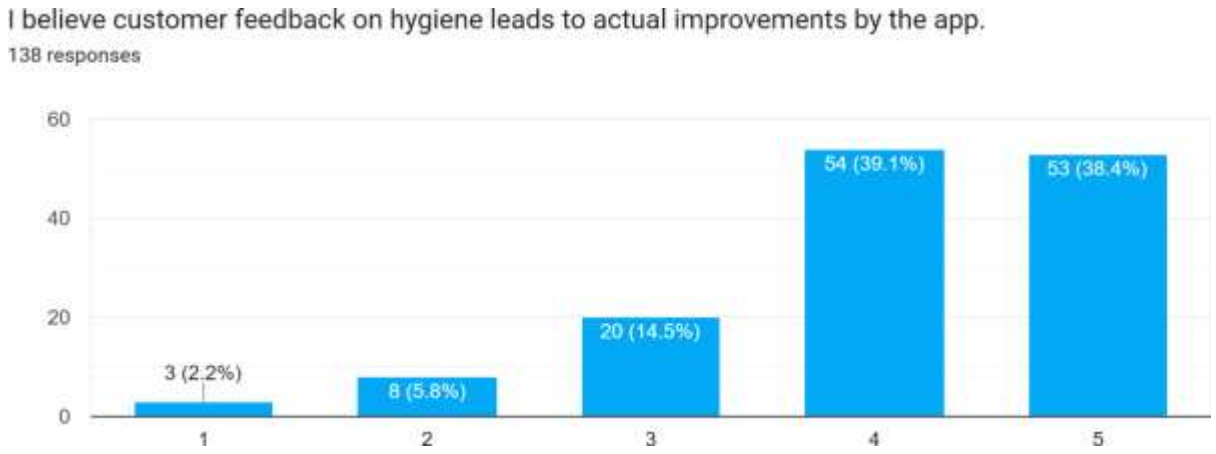


FIGURE 5.2:12 CUSTOMER FEEDBACK ON HYGIENE

INFERENCE

Most respondents believe that customer feedback on hygiene effectively leads to improvements by the delivery app. About 77.5% rated their agreement as 4 or 5, showing strong confidence in feedback-driven changes. Only a small minority (8%) disagreed or were neutral, indicating overall positive trust in the feedback process. The majority of respondents believe that customer feedback regarding hygiene leads to actual improvements by the delivery app.

CHAPTER - VI

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

CHAPTER VI

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Interpretations include inferential methods such as Chi-squared tests, ANOVA, correlation and regression to examine relationships among variables.

6.1 CHI-SQUARED TEST

Relevant: Variables

HYPOTHESES

Null Hypothesis (H_0):

There is no significant association between gender and confidence in food delivery hygiene.

Alternative Hypothesis (H_1):

There is a significant association between gender and confidence in food delivery hygiene.

TABLE 6.1:1 CHI-SQUARE TABLE SHOWING GENDER VS CONFIDENCE IN HYGIENE PRACTICES

```
Chi-square Test Statistic: 19.646581873993558
P-value: 0.000586351829635087
```

RESULTS

Chi-square statistic*:* 19.64

p-value**:** 0.005

INTERPRETATION:

The chi-square test shows a significant association between the variables studied. Since the p-value (0.00058) is less than 0.05, the null hypothesis is rejected. This means perceptions of food delivery safety and hygiene differ across groups.

6.2 CHI-SQUARE TEST 2

Relevant: Variables 2

HYPOTHESES:

Null Hypothesis (H_0):

There is no significant association between displaying hygiene-related certifications on food delivery apps and a user's willingness to try new restaurants.

Alternative Hypothesis (H_1):

There is a significant association between displaying hygiene-related certifications on food delivery apps and a user's willingness to try new restaurants.

TABLE 6.2.2 CHI-SQUARE HYGIENE TABLE SHOWING AWARENESS VS SAFE PRACTICES

```
=== Chi-Square: Hygiene Awareness vs Safe Practice ===
Chi-Square Statistic: 1.5
P-value: 0.4723665527410149
Degrees of Freedom: 2
Expected Frequencies:
 [[0.66666667 1.33333333]
 [0.66666667 1.33333333]
 [0.66666667 1.33333333]]
No significant association between Hygiene Awareness and Safe Practice
```

KEY RESULTS:

The chi-square test shows no significant association between hygiene awareness and safe practice, as the p-value (0.47) is greater than 0.05. This suggests that higher awareness of hygiene does not necessarily translate into safer food delivery practices among respondents.

INTERPRETATION:

The chi-square analysis indicates that there is no statistically significant association between hygiene awareness and safe practices. This means respondents' awareness levels do not strongly influence their actual behavior regarding food delivery safety and hygiene.

6.3 ONE-WAY ANOVA TEST

Relevant: Variables

HYPOTHESES

Null Hypothesis (H_0):

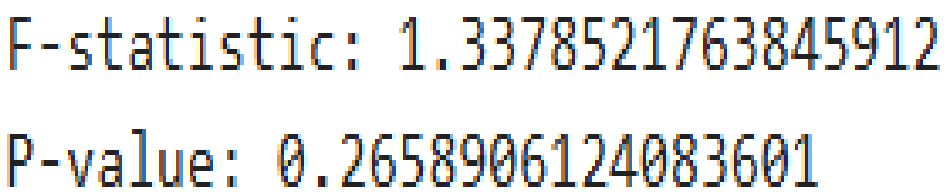
There is no significant difference between education and confidence in food safety

Alternative Hypothesis (H_1):

There is a significant difference between education and confidence in food safety

TABLE 6.3:1 ANOVA TABLE SHOWING EDUCATION VS. CONFIDENCE IN FOOD SAFETY

Relevant: Variables



KEY RESULTS

F Statistic: 1.34

P Value: 0.266

INFERENCE

There is no statistically significant difference between education and confidence in food safety

6.4 ONE-WAY ANOVA TEST 2

HYPOTHESES

Null hypothesis (h_0):

There is no significant difference between age groups and confidence.

Alternative Hypothesis (H_1):

There is a significant difference between age groups and confidence.

TABLE 6.3:1 ANOVA TABLE SHOWING CONFIDENCE ACROSS DEMOGRAPHIC GROUPS (E.G., AGE_GROUP)

```
=== ANOVA: Confidence by Age Group ===
F-statistic: 4.0
P-value: 0.14242717305466185
No significant difference in confidence across age groups
```

KEY RESULTS:

The ANOVA test produced an F-statistic of 4.0 with a p-value of 0.142, which is greater than 0.05.

INTERPRETATION:

This indicates there is no statistically significant difference in confidence levels regarding hygiene practices across different age groups.

6.5 CORRELATION

HYPOTHESES:

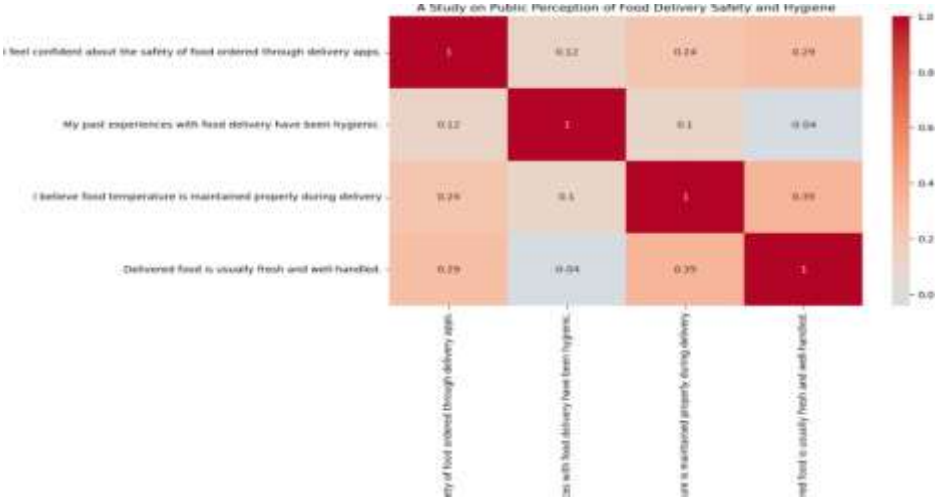
Null Hypothesis (H_0):

There is no significant relationship between people's confidence in food safety and other related perceptions.

Alternative Hypothesis (H_1):

There is a significant relationship between people's confidence in food safety and other related perceptions.

TABLE 6.5:1 CORRELATION TABLE SHOWING HOW CONFIDENT ARE PEOPLE IN HYGIENE PRACTICES?



KEY RESULTS:

The correlation heatmap shows mostly weak to moderate positive correlations among variables such as confidence in food safety, hygiene of past experiences, proper temperature maintenance, and freshness of delivered food. The highest correlation (0.35) is between proper temperature maintenance and freshness of delivered food, while some correlations (e.g., hygiene with freshness at -0.04) are negligible.

INTERPRETATION:

This suggests that customer confidence in food delivery safety is slightly influenced by perceptions of freshness and temperature maintenance, but overall, the relationships among these factors are weak. Companies should particularly focus on improving food temperature control and freshness, as they are more strongly linked to positive customer perceptions

6.6 REGRESSION

HYPOTHESIS:

Null Hypothesis (H0):

There is no significant relationship between confidence and safety of food ordered through delivery apps.

Alternative Hypothesis (HA):

There is a significant relationship between confidence and safety of food ordered through delivery apps.

TABLE 6.6:1 REGRESSION TABLE SHOWING HOW CONFIDENT ABOUT THE SAFETY OF FOOD ORDERED THROUGH DELIVERY APPS

OLS Regression Results

Dep. Variable:	I feel confident about the safety of food ordered through delivery apps.	R-squared:	0.262
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.234
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	9.359
Date:	Wed, 17 Sep 2025	Prob (F-statistic):	1.19e-07
Time:	17:55:44	Log-Likelihood:	-161.94
No. Observations:	138	AIC:	335.9
Df Residuals:	132	BIC:	353.4
Df Model:	5		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P>|t|	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.1235	0.483	2.328	0.021	0.169	2.078
My past experiences with food delivery have been hygienic.	0.0491	0.075	0.651	0.516	-0.100	0.198
Hygiene ratings displayed on apps influence my ordering decisions.	0.1332	0.088	1.516	0.132	-0.041	0.307
Seeing clear hygiene guidelines on the app increases my trust in ordering food.	0.2181	0.076	2.862	0.005	0.067	0.369
I trust that food is kept at a safe temperature during delivery.	0.1594	0.076	2.085	0.039	0.008	0.311
I believe insulated delivery bags are regularly cleaned and sanitised.	0.1704	0.070	2.421	0.017	0.031	0.310

Omnibus:	3.790	Durbin-Watson:	1.618
Prob(Omnibus):	0.150	Jarque-Bera (JB):	3.827
Skew:	-0.378	Prob(JB):	0.148
Kurtosis:	2.692	Cond. No.	64.8

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

KEY RESULTS:

- F-statistic: 9.359
- Prob (F-statistic): 0.000000119
- R-squared: 0.262
- Adj. R-squared: 0.234

INTERPRETATION:

- We reject the null hypothesis (H0). This means the overall model is statistically significant and is useful for explaining customer confidence.

CHAPTER - VII
BUSINESS IMPLICATIONS

CHAPTER VII

BUSINESS IMPLICATIONS

7.1 ROLE IN DECISION-MAKING

The study on public perception of food delivery safety and hygiene plays a crucial role in guiding decision-making for companies, restaurants, and regulators. By understanding consumer concerns about hygiene practices, packaging safety, and delivery processes, businesses can identify priority areas for improvement and build stronger trust with customers. The insights from this research also help regulators develop more effective guidelines and monitoring systems to ensure food safety. Ultimately, the findings provide a data-driven basis for making informed decisions that enhance service quality, increase customer satisfaction, and strengthen the overall safety of the food delivery ecosystem.

7.2 POTENTIAL IMPACT ON COST, REVENUE, EFFICIENCY, OR CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE

- **Cost & Revenue:** Investing in safer packaging and hygiene may raise costs initially, but it builds customer trust and drives higher long-term revenue.
- **Efficiency:** Standardized hygiene and delivery practices reduce delays, errors, and wastage, improving overall operational efficiency.
- **Customer Experience:** Safe and clean deliveries enhance satisfaction, loyalty, and brand reputation, leading to repeat business and positive word-of-mouth.

7.3 RECOMMENDATIONS

- **For Companies:** Adopt technology-driven tracking systems to monitor hygiene compliance from kitchen to doorstep.
- **For Restaurants:** Regularly sanitize kitchen and storage areas, and clearly label “packed on” and “use by” dates on deliveries.
- **For Delivery Partners:** Provide ongoing hygiene training and incentivize safe delivery practices through performance rewards.
- **For Regulators:** Introduce certifications or “Hygiene Ratings” for food delivery platforms to enhance consumer confidence.
- **For Companies & Restaurants:** Use eco-friendly yet safe packaging to balance

hygiene with sustainability concerns.

- **For Platforms:** Collect customer feedback on hygiene regularly and integrate it into quality improvement processes.
- **For Regulators:** Implement penalties for repeated violations of hygiene standards to ensure accountability.
- **For Customers:** Encourage adoption of digital payments and app-based feedback to reduce contact and improve monitoring.

CHAPTER - VIII

LIMITATIONS AND FUTURE SCOPE

CHAPTER VIII

LIMITATIONS AND FUTURE SCOPE

8.1 CHALLENGES FACED

- **Maintaining Consistency:** Ensuring uniform hygiene practices across multiple restaurants and delivery partners is difficult to monitor.
- **Cost Burden:** Implementing high-quality packaging and strict hygiene standards increases operational expenses for businesses.
- **Delivery Handling:** Maintaining food safety during long delivery times or extreme weather remains a major challenge.
- **Consumer Awareness:** Many customers lack awareness of proper hygiene indicators, making it harder to demand accountability.
- **Regulatory Compliance:** Varying local laws and weak enforcement often lead to inconsistent safety practices across regions.

8.2 FUTURE SCOPE

The future of food delivery safety and hygiene lies in the integration of advanced technologies. Tools such as AI, IoT sensors, and real-time tracking can help monitor hygiene practices from the kitchen to the customer's doorstep, ensuring transparency and trust in the delivery process.

Another important area of development is the standardization of hygiene protocols. Introducing tamper-proof, eco-friendly packaging and creating recognized hygiene certifications for restaurants and delivery platforms can help build consumer confidence and ensure consistent practices across the industry.

Finally, greater involvement of both customers and regulators will shape the future scope. Feedback-driven improvements, stricter government audits, and clear policy frameworks can make hygiene compliance mandatory, ultimately leading to safer, more reliable, and customer-friendly food delivery systems.

CHAPTER - IX

CONCLUSION

CHAPTER IX

CONCLUSION

9.1 FINDINGS

- Many respondents showed only moderate confidence in hygiene practices, highlighting the need for clearer communication and transparency in food handling.
- Packaging quality, especially sealed and tamper-proof containers, emerged as a strong determinant of customer trust and perception of safety.
- Contactless delivery has gained significant importance post-pandemic, with many customers preferring minimal interaction for health reasons.
- Delivery staff hygiene and training were found to be inconsistent, leading to reduced confidence in overall food safety.
- Delays in delivery time not only affected food freshness but also negatively influenced perceptions of hygiene and reliability.
- Younger customers were more open to adopting digital hygiene verification methods, such as in-app ratings and safety badges.
- Older respondents expressed greater reliance on regulatory checks and official assurance rather than company-driven claims.
- A majority of customers identified packaging methods and delivery handling as the key areas requiring immediate improvement.
- Respondents showed strong demand for standardized hygiene guidelines across restaurants and delivery platforms to ensure consistency.

STATISTICAL FINDINGS:

- A significant proportion of respondents expressed only moderate confidence in hygiene practices, indicating gaps in assurance.
- Regression analysis showed that packaging quality and sealed delivery strongly influence perceptions of overall safety.
- Chi-square tests revealed associations between demographic factors (such as age) and hygiene awareness, with younger groups showing higher adaptability to digital safety measures.
- ANOVA results suggested differences in hygiene perception across occupational groups, with service professionals showing stricter expectations.

- Correlation analysis confirmed a positive relationship between improved hygiene practices and customer loyalty/likelihood of repeat orders.

9.2 VALUE ADDITION TO BUSINESS & MANAGEMENT

This study provides significant value to both business and management by highlighting how public perception of safety and hygiene directly impacts trust, loyalty, and repeat purchases. The findings enable businesses to strengthen hygiene practices, adopt tamper-proof packaging, and train delivery staff, thereby improving customer confidence and service quality. For management, the insights serve as a guide for making strategic decisions related to operations, cost control, and investment in technology. Moreover, companies adopting these practices gain a competitive advantage, while regulators and policymakers can use the outcomes to frame effective guidelines. Ultimately, the research adds value by aligning customer expectations with business strategies, ensuring sustainable growth and stronger brand reputation

9.3 FINAL REMARKS

This research underscores the critical role of hygiene and safety in shaping customer trust in the food delivery ecosystem. The findings reveal that customer perceptions are strongly influenced by packaging standards, delivery practices, and overall transparency in hygiene processes. With growing consumer awareness, businesses can no longer treat hygiene as an afterthought but as a central element of service quality.

For companies and restaurants, this study highlights the opportunity to strengthen customer loyalty by investing in safe packaging, sealed deliveries, and staff training on hygiene protocols. By aligning their practices with customer expectations, businesses can not only improve satisfaction but also gain a competitive edge in a highly crowded marketplace. Furthermore, the results indicate that efficient hygiene practices reduce risks of complaints, negative reviews, and reputational damage.

From a broader perspective, this study provides value to managers, policymakers, and regulators by showcasing how perceptions of safety can guide strategic decision-making. As the food delivery sector continues to expand, adopting a proactive approach to hygiene will remain essential. Ultimately, improving hygiene standards is not just about compliance, but about building long-term trust, enhancing brand value, and ensuring sustainable growth in the industry.

APPENDICES

APPENDIX A
JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS AND RESEARCH ARTICLES

Vandenhaute, H., Gellynck, X., & De Steur, H. (2022). COVID-19 safety measures in the food service sector: Consumers' attitudes and transparency perceptions at three different stages of the Pandemic. *Foods*, *11*(6), 810.

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APPENDIX B
QUESTIONNAIRE

PART A

Age

Gender

- Male
- Female

Educational Qualification

- School level
- Undergraduate
- Postgraduate

Occupation

- Student
- Professional
- Employee
- Other:

Place of Residence

- Urban
- Semi-Urban
- Rural

PART B

- ***For each question below are arranged by 1-5 linear scale:***
- ***1 = Strongly Disagree***
- ***2 = Disagree,***
- ***3 = Neutral,***
- ***4 = Agree,***

- ***5 = Strongly Agree***

My past experiences with food delivery have been hygienic.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

Do you think food safety and hygiene are important for food delivery services?

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

Seeing clear hygiene guidelines on the app increases my trust in ordering food.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

Hygiene ratings displayed on apps influence my ordering decisions.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2

- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

I feel comfortable ordering from a new restaurant if it is listed on a well-known delivery app.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

Do you think government authorities should monitor food delivery hygiene more strictly?

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

Have you ever received food that appeared unhygienic or unsafe (e.g., open packaging, spillage)?

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5

- Strongly Agree

Delivered food is usually fresh and well-handled.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

I believe food temperature is maintained properly during delivery

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

I prefer delivery services that clearly display hygiene ratings of restaurants.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

I feel confident about the safety of food ordered through delivery apps.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2

- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree
- **I would prefer food delivery services that use smart containers to keep food fresh.**
- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

I believe customer feedback on hygiene leads to actual improvements by the app.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

Food delivery apps should show when the food was last inspected by health authorities

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

Late-night food deliveries maintain the same hygiene standards as daytime deliveries.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

Hygiene-related certifications displayed on apps influence my willingness to try new restaurants.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

Frequent hygiene updates from apps improve my perception of their responsibility.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

I would avoid ordering from a restaurant if hygiene information is not available on the app.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3

- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

I believe insulated delivery bags are regularly cleaned and sanitized.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree

I trust that food is kept at a safe temperature during delivery.

- Strongly Disagree
- 1
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- Strongly Agree